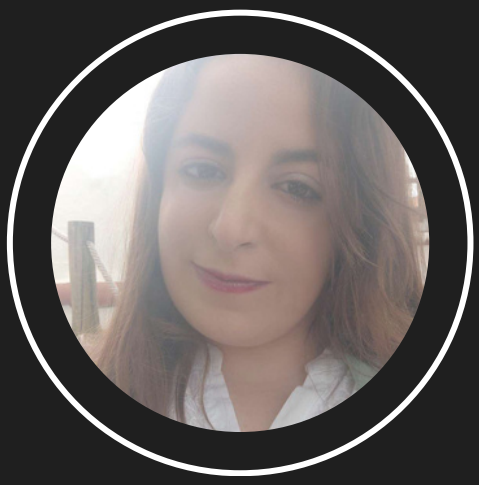

Ana Lúcia Coimbra

UX Research & Service Design

Healthcare & Tech Specialist

UX Researcher and Service Design specialist with 6+ years of experience across healthcare and technology. Trained as an occupational therapist, where systematic observation and task analysis were clinical assessment tools applied daily, not methodologies learned from a course. That foundation, combined with experience as a healthcare systems analyst working across clinical, technical and business stakeholders, brings a systems thinking lens to understanding how people, processes and technology interact. Skilled in end-to-end mixed-methods research, uncovering what people genuinely need versus what they think they need and translating those insights into strategies that inform product and business decisions.

EDUCATION

OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY

Bachelor's Degree

Polytechnic of Leiria/School of Health Sciences

CONTACT ME

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WORK EXPERIENCE

UX Researcher — 2024 - 2025

Freelancer I Lisbon Metropolitan Area (remote)

- **Planned and conducted end-to-end UX research** for an early-stage startup developing a shopping preparation and price comparison platform to understand user needs, behaviours, and motivations that **informed product strategy and roadmap prioritisation**:
  - **Executed comprehensive generative research using mixed methods** (user interviews, observation, task analysis, surveys, competitive analysis), identifying patterns and unmet needs in shopping preparation workflows;
  - Developed detailed user knowledge profiles/behavioural typologies based on 26 in-depth interviews, with **comprehensive task analysis variations** for each typology and task optimisation recommendations targeting critical task dimensions where technology could reduce manual effort, cognitive load, and error risk;
  - **Delivered actionable insights** through a 56-slide strategic report and interactive Miro board containing all research deliverables (profiles, task analysis/optimisation, competitive benchmarking, prioritisation matrix, research insights and recommendations), enabling **data-driven product decisions**.

Healthcare Systems Analyst — 2019 - 2022

Maxdata Software SA | Lisbon Metropolitan Area (hybrid)

Maxdata is a Portuguese healthcare software company with around 50 employees, specialising in clinical and anatomical pathology labs and blood bank solutions, with additional support for epidemiology and related fields.

- Selected for healthcare industry knowledge to join the assistance and support team, specialising in functional analysis, customer support, and QA analysis in a B2B agile environment:
  - **Bridged user needs with technical capabilities** by gathering stakeholder requirements and creating comprehensive documentation, while working with development teams to design solutions that matched real-world healthcare workflows;
  - **Identified and resolved critical user pain points** through systematic support ticket analysis, mapping recurring issues to specific workflow mismatches between user expectations and system design and **creating FAQ documentation that consistently ranked as the top-viewed client resources, reducing repetitive support tickets;**
  - **Implemented and maintained laboratory software solutions for 1200+ healthcare professionals across 6+ organisations**, collaborating with physicians, nurses, and lab technicians to understand evolving clinical workflows and translate needs into effective system configurations.

Business Owner — 2017 - 2018

Inspiring Care I Porto Metropolitan Area (hybrid)

Inspiring Care was a healthtech business project that leveraged technology to support therapists in optimising their daily practices for better patient outcomes. I founded it while participating in the "Empreende Já" entrepreneurship programme and the EMER-N business mentorship project.

- **Conducted generative research** to understand user needs, behaviours and motivations through user interviews, field research, focus groups and competitive analysis, synthesising findings into actionable insights for product and business decisions;
- Presented detailed business plan and research findings to programme jury and StartUp Portugal assessors, achieving a **4.35/5 final score** that validated project viability;
- Delivered research insights and business strategy to business angels through compelling presentations with data visualisations that demonstrated **product-market fit** and business viability.

OTHER ACTIVITIES

- Authored a systematic review thesis called "The Efficacy Of The Constraint-Induced Movement Therapy In Individuals With Post-Stroke Hemipalsy: A Systematic Review";
- Collaborated on 3+ systematic reviews (rigorous academic research syntheses) post-graduation.

LANGUAGES

- Native Portuguese
- Full Professional English (C1)
- Professional Working Spanish (B2)
- Limited Working French (A2)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified as an instructor (with a Portuguese certificate of pedagogical competence, issued by the IEFP, July 2018);
- Additional certifications, including "Fundamentals of Business Analysis" (May 2022), "Fundamentals of Project Planning and Management" (February 2019), "Strategizing Products and Customer Experiences (SPACE)" (April 2024), "User Research - Methods and Best Practices" (September 2022) and "Improve Your Presentation Writing - Public Speaking - Work Presentations" (October 2024).

SKILLS

RESEARCH METHODS & ANALYSIS

- Proficient in **qualitative and quantitative research methodologies**, including user interviews, field research (contextual inquiry and observation), surveys, task analysis, user knowledge profiles (personas), thematic analysis, competitive analysis, focus groups, task flows, task optimisation, among others;
- Knowledge of A/B testing, usability testing, customer journey mapping, card sorting and similar methodologies;
- Strong **analytical skills and behavioural analysis** grounded in formal clinical assessment training and practice.

DOMAIN EXPERTISE

- Healthcare systems and clinical workflows (5+ organisations, 800+ users);
- Accessibility standards and assistive technology, including extensive knowledge of disabilities, neurodiverse conditions, neurological and musculoskeletal pathologies;
- Experience with **complex, regulated systems**;
- Experience mapping multi-actor workflows across front and back-office touchpoints in complex service environments;
- **Cross-functional collaboration and stakeholder management** across technical, clinical and business teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Research tools:** Miro, Dovetail, Figma, Google Forms, Calendly, Google Meet;
- **General tools:** Google Workspace, Microsoft Office (Word, PowerPoint), Notion, Slack, Adobe Photoshop;
- QA testing experience with SQL (with Oracle and Postgres databases), DBeaver;
- Strong organisational skills with **evidence-based approach**;
- Quickly adapts to new tools and platforms based on research needs;
- Familiarity with: Jira, Confluence, Zoom, Airtable, Maze.

COMMUNICATION

- Excellent interpersonal communication and active listening;
- Strong writing skills in English and Portuguese;
- Ability to communicate complex research concepts clearly to both technical and non-technical audiences.